

Game prototype: M.U.T.E.

Core concept:

M.U.T.E. is a tactical stealth game where the player depends entirely on a multifunctional device to communicate, hack, and manipulate the environment. The twist is that the device makes sound and runs on a manual-crank battery system, meaning using it always comes with risk.

Technology is powerful, but it constantly exposes you.

The player must balance movement, sound awareness, Resource management, placement, and survival without tech when necessary. The entire experience revolves around the idea that over-reliance on technology can become dangerous.

Core gameplay systems:

M.u.t.e Device:

A device that the player uses to communicate with their operators about the current objective, hacking cameras, or even making a sound. The device can be unequipped and placed anywhere, so unsuspecting enemies look at it and pick it up, only to be rendered unconscious the second. However, after a short period, the enemy will pick it up and stash it on their person, meaning that you have to retrieve it and refocus on the mission at hand.

The device uses a d-pad button scheme, often found on video game controllers.

Perspective System:

Normal Gameplay – Third Person:

The game is played in third-person while moving, sneaking, cqc, and exploring.

This allows: Better spatial awareness, seeing patrol routes, and planning stealth paths

Third-person keeps the player tactical and aware.

Device & Interaction Mode – First Person:

The camera switches to first-person when: cranking the device, hacking, communicating, deploying trap mode, tying enemies, using guns, and using medical cloth.

This limits vision and increases tension. While in first-person, the player becomes more vulnerable because they cannot see behind them.

Third-person = control

First-person = vulnerability

Movement:

- Walk
- Run (stamina-based)
- Crouch
- Prone

Each stance affects movement speed and sound output.

Resources:

Weapons:

- Guns (use them to shoot people)
- Tranquilizers (similar to guns, but not made for lethal purposes)

- Ammo (how else would the gun fire?)
- Silencers (use for quieter kills or takeouts)
- Knife (a second option when all ammo is gone)

Utility:

- Cardboard box (someone left a bandana in it, weird)
- Multi-vision goggles (seem as though they've already been used for quite a while)
- Rope (used to tie up enemies or to latch onto a grappable ledge)
- Cloth (use it to stop bleeding, stop enemies from talking, or to blind enemies)
- Your hands(they've been trained for throwing and CQC)

Players can choose lethal or non-lethal playstyles.

The Environment (Allows for Guerrilla Warfare):

The environment of each mission will, of course, differ, but some things to note are:

- **Bushes:** make sound the moment you enter or leave the bush, but while inside it, you're nearly undetectable
- **"Boxes":** hide inside one, and move carefully with it; enemies will know someone is inside the box once you move while they look at you, but standing still while they look at you will make them simply pass by you
- **"Pillars":** either tree logs or pillars within buildings, hide on one side of them, and enemies won't see you from at least 3 angles
- **"Vents":** crawl into them to avoid detection, but if the enemy is close to one, they'll survey the area, try not to move or be seen in a vent opening, or they'll kill you

Enemies and hazards:

Enemies are categorized by weight class and experience.

Weight Classes:

Light: Fast, Fragile, Light weaponry

Medium: Balanced, Standard weapons

Heavy: Slow, Durable, Heavy artillery

Types:

Rookies: Fall for obvious traps, Slower reactions, Poor coordination

Veterans: Investigate in groups, Communicate with allies, Recognize sound patterns, Recover unconscious teammates, and will kill on sight

Cameras: Either stationary or moving around, avoiding them is the best option, but if spotted, game over for you.

Illuminated: when any bright light source illuminates you, you'll of course be seen and perhaps killed. Making darkness your ally would be better for the long term.

Interference Zones:

Certain areas interfere with the device.

Signal Jammers: Disable communication, prevent hacking. The device still makes noise, but has no effect

EMP Zones: Instantly drain the battery, Temporarily disable the device

Industrial Areas: Distort sound, Increase detection range, Cause device instability

These areas force players to rely less on tech and more on movement and positioning.

Sound Propagation System

Every sound in the game creates a visible radius.

Sound Sources: Walking, Running, Cranking, Device activation, Gunfire, Opening doors

Environmental Effects: Metal surfaces increase sound radius, Carpet reduces sound, Thick walls block sound, and opening doors increases sound travel

Enemy Reaction Levels:

Outer Radius: Light suspicion, Slow investigation

Middle Radius: Move directly to sound, Alert nearby allies

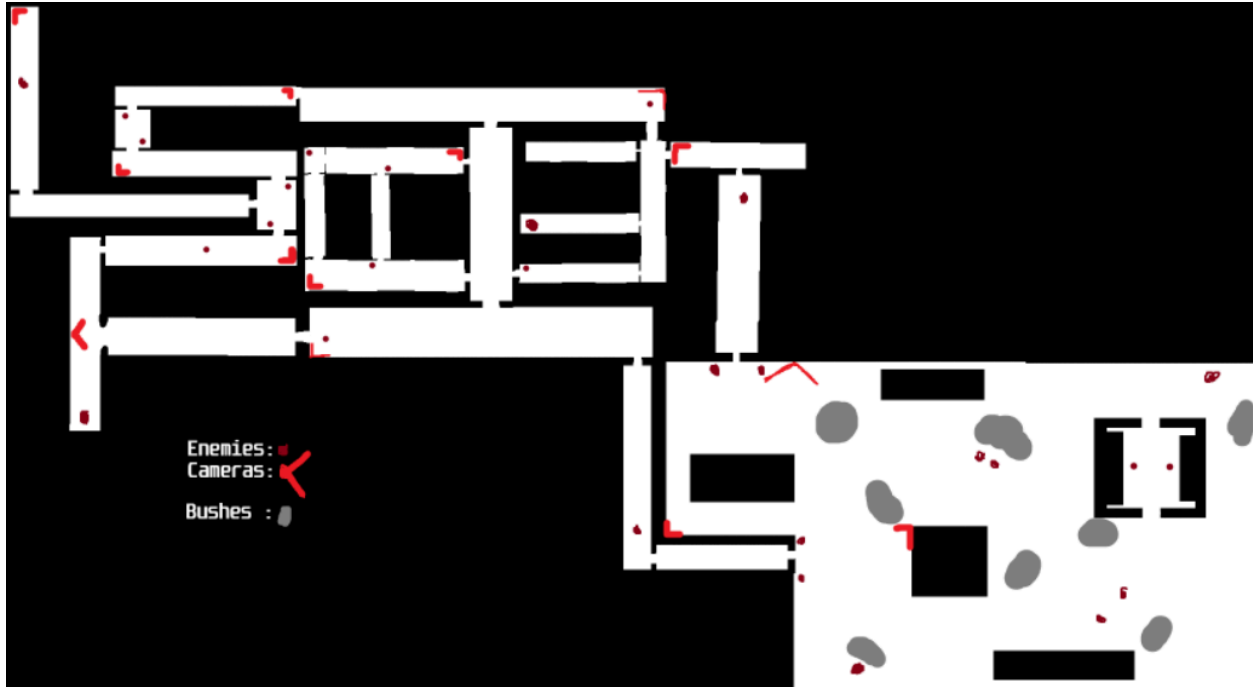
Inner Radius: Immediate alert state, Weapons drawn, Area sweep begins

Rookies are more likely to fall for obvious distractions and traps.

Veterans can recognize repeated or unnatural sounds, including the rhythmic pattern of cranking.

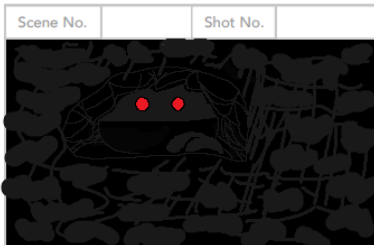
The intro level:

This level is designed to introduce the player to an open environment, then an enclosed one, with the first serving as a tutorial and the other showing how the game will mostly play. This level is simply a test to see if my entire concept "works" as in everything does as intended, and is simply a placeholder since I don't even know how stealth level layouts work, hell, the layout has letters from the word "stealth" for gods sake, some rotated or elongated. I also noticed I forgot to include an underlight mechanic in the level.

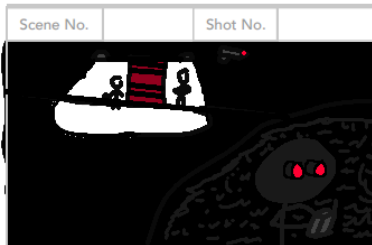


Title: **M.U.T.E. INTRO / Tutorial**

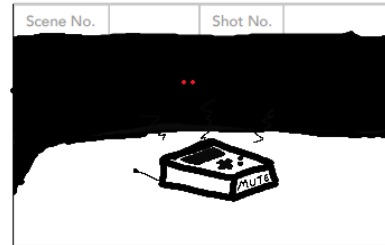
Page:



you start the infiltration/ Tutorial hiding in the bushes as a guard previously walked by, giving the player a clue as how bushes can be used in the game



survey the area to know what your up against, and prepare for what ever method suits you best. but the main one will be for the main tool you'll most likely use



Behold, the M.U.T.E Device! This device allows communication to happen when on a mission, but also has hacking capabilities and can even make any sound on demand. But be careful, enemies who think such device isn't a threat will carry it, meaning you have to get it back as you only have one



Other resources include guns, tranquilizers, ammo, silencers and a knife (a last resort when you're all out of ammo). In this scenario, a gun is used to take out the camera and the light above the first guards head, but what to do with the second guard?



When no other options are left, you can use your hands to perform some close quarters combat and either knockout or kill the enemy, as demonstrated by this illustration



now that the basic mechanics have been covered in an open area, how will you fare against a much more enclosed area with only one device helping you out?

Also I wasn't sure what to do with the story board since the assignment just says "use a storyboard" so I just basically explained the basic mechanics you need to know for the beginning area.